

Perform or Perish

The people of India are unforgiving for time-servers and freeloaders ("The Comeback Couple", May 25). The verdict is in favour of performing governments who are concerned with alleviation of poverty, removal of sleaze, illiteracy and homelessness, and not empty rhetoric, religious fanaticism, narcissist proclivities and opportunists swinging with the wind.

R.J. KHURANA, *Bhopal*

Passing the Baton

The Rahul Gandhi factor in the Congress election campaign indicates induction of young blood into the UPA ("The Rahul Offensive", May 18). This will pave the way for improved performance of the party and will give it another chance to govern and complete unfinished tasks without interference of the Left.

K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

System Overhaul

Over the years, political formations carved out of fractured mandates have concentrated more on sharing the spoils than looking after the national interest ("What India needs", May 11). No country can survive if public affairs are conducted in such an undesirable manner. People should elect honest and upright men, instead of selling democracy for freebies.

K.S. THAMPI, *Chennai*

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One fails to understand why our judicial system takes so much time to deliver justice, even in trivial felonies ("A Case for Prosecution", May 11).

The soaring crime rate is the result of this delay. The people have lost their faith in the judiciary as an accused can easily escape unpunished if he has sound political or financial backing.

IPPILI SANTHOSH KUMAR,
via www.indiatoday.in

fabulous returns in recessionary times. This could be a good case study for our premier business schools.

G.S. SHARMA, *Jaipur*

Two Good

Manmohan Singh outsourcing the PMO to 10 Janpath is a strategic move to ensure full energies on implementation ("Buy One Get Two", April 27). The odd couple has managed to cobble

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI



“ Naveen Patnaik's victory proves that you don't have to create votebanks if your governance is development- and people-driven. They will be automatically crafted for you. ”

SUDHIR MISHRA, via www.indiatoday.in

Money Poser

When the entire world, including India, is facing its worst recession, wiping out half of the net worth of one and all, it is baffling to see 'declared' assets of politicians growing manifold since 2004 ("The Wealth Effect, May 11"). It will be enlightening to know which legitimate-vocation could yield such

together a team of P. Chidambaram, Pranab Mukherjee, Kapil Sibal, Abhishek Singhvi, Montek Singh Ahluwalia and Anand Sharma who have ensured that national interests were served by avoiding petty confrontations and territorial differences.

MARUTPAL BHATTACHARYA,
Pune

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

JULY 16-31, 1979

Views, Old and New

For someone who found it hard to make up his mind about politics, last week was a time for clear thinking. The balding, blundering son of the former prime minister was formally welcomed back into the fold of his mother's embattled party, the Congress(I); his wife Maneka was providing additional power at his elbow. Splashing him on the cover of *Surya*, the scandal-mongering magazine she edits from the capital, Sanjay's thoughts spewed forth inside in a 10-page interview, not all of them complimentary but frequently contradictory. Behind every young man on the make there is a woman. Behind Sanjay there are now two. Sanjay maintained in the recent *Surya* interview that he had never entered politics "in the strict sense," that he was never associated with R.K. Dhawan, Bansi Lal, Om Mehta, V.C. Shukla and Dharendra Brahmachari, and that D.K. Barooah, Congress president during the Emergency was a "professional sycophant".

Sunil Sethi



BANSI LAL, N.D. TEWARI AND SANJAY